

DAVID ALLAN

TECHNICAL DIRECTOR VES AWARD WINNER

PROFILE

Technical Director designing and deploying artist-centric pipeline and workflow systems in high-performance production environments.

Architected a studio-wide automation framework at Important Looking Pirates (ILP), embedding within production teams to translate complex artist and supervisor workflows into scalable systems.

Actively developing an understanding of emerging GenAI workflows and their integration into traditional CG pipelines, with a focus on how these systems can support artist-driven production workflows.

Will be contributing to virtual production system development at UC Irvine, focusing on real-time tracking and projection-based workflows.

TECHNICAL STACK

PIPELINE & WORKFLOW

- Pipeline Architecture
- Workflow Design
- Automation Systems
- Tool Development

DCC & RENDERING

Houdini, Maya, Nuke, Arnold

LANGUAGES

Python, C#, Java, SQL

EDUCATION

University of California, Irvine

Machine Learning, Computer Graphics & AI
(2025 – 2026)

Virtual Production Lab – Project Contribution
(Starting April 2026)

Lund University

B.Sc. in Computer Science and Informatics
(Ongoing), 2023 – Present

CONTACT

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EXPERIENCE

Pipeline & Tool Development (2020 – 2025)

Important Looking Pirates (ILP)

- Architected the Python-based Job Chain automation framework, enabling multi-step, cross-department workflows tailored to show-specific production requirements.
- Developed production tools for CFX, grooming, and asset workflows, reducing manual iteration and improving artist efficiency.
- Built deployment and release systems supporting versioned rollouts, rollback, and safe experimentation across production.
- Developed orchestration systems automating complex task chains in high-throughput environments.
- Built pipeline tooling including asset ingestion, scene population, and grooming systems used across multiple shows.
- Embedded within production teams as both Technical Director and artist, identifying show-specific workflow bottlenecks and rapidly iterating on tools and processes to deliver scalable, production-ready solutions.

NOTABLE PROJECTS

- **Ronja, the Robber's Daughter (2024) — VES Award Winner**
Led grooming and look development for the Queen Harpy while designing cross-department workflows.
- **Indiana Jones and the Dial of Destiny (2023)**
Designed and deployed a grooming and hair simulation pipeline improving artist workflows.
- **Stranger Things, Season 4 (2022)**
Developed creature FX simulations and contributed to scalable pipeline automation systems.
- **Star Wars: The Mandalorian, Season 2 (2020)**
Lighting, lookdev, and environment work alongside tool development in production.
- **Jurassic World: Fallen Kingdom (2018)**
Lighting, lookdev, and environment work on a large-scale feature production.